

Financial Inclusion Granting Program Application

APPLICANT INFORMATION

Mrs.	Sarah	Lovenuk	
Title	First Name	Last Name	
Secretary Board Member		info@blackbarnfarms.ca	18076205916
Position		Preferred Contact Email	Phone

ORGANIZATION INFORMATION

807 Food Co-operative Inc.		106-60 Princess St.	
Organization Legal Name		Address	
Dryden	ON	P0V 2W0	
City	Province	Postal Code	Phone
the807foodcoop@gmail.com		807foodcoop.ca	
Organization Email		Organization Website	
Organization Social Media Handles:			
Facebook	Instagram	LinkedIn	X

Other (please specify)

Is the organization currently a member of Alterna Savings? ☒ Yes ☐ No

Is the individual filling out this application currently a member of Alterna Savings or a client of Alterna Bank? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Which of the following best describes the applicant organization's legal structure?

☐ Registered Charity CRA #

☐ Incorporated Nonprofit

☒ Co-operative without Share Capital

☐ Unincorporated Association

ABOUT YOUR ORGANIZATION

Describe what the organization does. Highlight the organization's vision/mission/goals. (200 words maximum)

Our Mission is to empower communities in Northwestern Ontario by utilizing food as a catalyst for change. Through our grassroots food hub, we strive to foster self-sufficiency, sustainability, and social impact. By connecting people & resources while addressing social needs, we build resilient communities.

Our Vision is to design a system where communities rely on vibrant hubs that champion self-sufficiency, prioritize local food exchange, and create opportunities for social impact. We aspire to empower, inform and educate generations to come, enabling them to embrace their inherent potential and actively participate in building resilient, self-reliant communities in Northwestern Ontario.

\$20,000 - \$100,000 (grant dependent for growth)

Northwestern Ontario

What is the organization's annual operating budget?

What is your organization's impact region?

2021

0

When was the organization founded?

How many individuals does the organization employ (FTE)?

20

How many volunteers support the organization?

Do you prepare audited financial statements? Yes ☒ No

DETAILS OF GRANT REQUEST

Codetry Plain-Language Decision-Support Tool for Rural Producers

Project/Program Name

November 2026

March 2027

20000

20000

Start Date

End Date

Amount Requested

Total Program/Project Budget

Budget Breakdown

Item

Amount

1:1 codetry tooling session with 10 members - Working with producers to u

5250

Design, Development and full integration of the custom financial literacy tool

7000

Member testing and survey sessions. Evaluating the impact of the tool for u

1750

Impact reporting Maintenance, Revisions & Board Handover

3500

Northwestern Ontario

Proposed Program/Project Impact Region

Detail any other significant funders of the organization/program/project which the grant request will support.

Describe your grant request and proposed Program/Project support. Highlight the community need and intended beneficiaries, including number of intended beneficiaries. (500 words maximum)

The 807 Food Co-op & Hub is a member-owned not-for-profit cooperative in Dryden, Northwestern Ontario. We run a local food hub that connects farmers, producers, and families across the 807 region online and in person. Our work keeps food dollars circulating locally and builds resilience in rural communities. We are requesting \$20,000 from Alterna's Financial Inclusion Grant to develop a plain-language "codetry" decision-support tool.

Community Need

Farmers and co-op members here regularly struggle with banking documents, legal contracts, health and safety regulations, grant forms, and consultant reports. These materials are written in dense professional language that most of us don't speak in daily life. As a result, good people miss out on financing they qualify for, vote on important co-op decisions without fully understanding the financial risks or benefits, or sign agreements that create problems later. This is

How does this proposed Program/Project align with the Financial Inclusion Granting Program criteria as outlined on Alterna's website? (200 words maximum)

The codetry tool project aligns most directly with Food Insecurity, one of Alterna's four 2026 causes for representation. By giving farmers and co-op members clear, everyday language around financial and legal documents, the tool helps them make better decisions on loans, investments, contracts, and regulations. Stronger financial understanding leads to more stable farms and a more resilient local food system — which directly supports reliable local food access and reduces food insecurity in rural Northwestern Ontario.

It also touches Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion by removing language barriers for rural producers who are often excluded by professional jargon. This promotes equitable participation in our co-op economy for everyday farmers and

Describe the financial education objective for the proposed Program/Project. (200 words maximum)

The primary financial education objective of this project is to equip our co-op members and 250+ local producers with the practical knowledge they need to understand complex financial and legal documents in their own everyday language. Through the codetry decision-support tool, members will learn to clearly see the real-world impacts of banking terms, loan conditions, contracts, regulations, and investment decisions. Instead of struggling with jargon, they will receive plain rural English explanations that show exactly how a document affects their wallet, their farm, their family, and their co-op. This hands-on tool turns financial education into something usable and immediate. Every time a member inputs a document, they gain knowledge about risks, benefits, costs, and options. Over time, this builds lasting financial confidence and literacy among rural producers who are often left out of traditional education programs. By the end of the

What opportunities exist for Alterna Savings' employees to volunteer with your organization and support your proposed Program/Project? (100 words maximum)

We welcome Alterna employees to get involved in two practical ways:

Codetry Language Workshop – At the start of the project, employees can join a short session (in-person or virtual) with our codetry practitioner and/or farmers. Your frontline staff know exactly which banking, loan, and financial terms confuse everyday clients. This input will help build our local "word bank" so the tool translates jargon into real rural language right from day one.

Co-op Events & Fundraising – Volunteers can help promote and run local food hub events, harvest festivals, or member

Outline how/if your organization's proposed Program/Project could run if the organization did not receive the full requested funding amount. (100 words maximum)

If we do not receive the full \$20,000 grant, we will not be able to proceed with the project at this time. The 807 Food Co-op operates on very tight margins with no surplus funds available for software development or contractor fees. Without this grant support, we lack the resources to hire the codetry practitioner and developer. In that case, we would pause the project, continue seeking other funding sources (such as provincial rural grants or crowdfunding from our members), and re-apply in the next grant cycle. We are fully committed to the idea but cannot move forward without dedicated funding.

Any additional information for Financial Inclusion Granting Program Committee consideration. (100 words maximum)

We are a small, grassroots rural food co-op with very limited operating funds. This \$20,000 grant would be the sole enabler for the entire project — there are no other current resources available to hire the codetory practitioner. The tool we are proposing is highly replicable. Once built and tested in Dryden, other Ontario food co-ops, farm hubs, and rural cooperatives can adopt or adapt it quickly. This creates a practical model for improving financial inclusion across underserved rural communities. We are deeply committed to this work because clearer financial understanding directly strengthens farms, co-op governance, and local food resilience. Thank you for considering our application.

SUBMISSION PROCESS

Step One: Financial Inclusion Granting Program Application

Applicant organizations must submit the following information before the indicated deadline to: community.grants@alterna.ca.

A complete application submission, depending on the organization's legal structure, will include:

1. Completed Application Form

2. Proof of Entity

- A copy of the organization's Articles of Incorporation or Letters Patent

Note: Certificate of Incorporation is not considered comprehensive as Proof of Entity

• Letter of Support (unincorporated associations only)

- A Letter of Support from an incorporated organization is required, along with the submission of the sponsor organization's Proof of Entity and any additional subsequent documentation.

Note: If selected as a recipient of the Community Granting Program, the cheque will be issued to the sponsoring incorporated organization. Alterna will only issue cheques to incorporated groups.

3. Proof of Charitable Status (if applicable)

- CRA number
- Notification of Registration Letter and Annual Information Returns (T3010) as proof of charitable status (requested).

Note: Proof of Entity is not considered Proof of Charitable Status.

Members and non-members of Alterna are required to submit the necessary documentation as outlined above depending on the applicant organization's legal structure. A **Letter of Recommendation** can be submitted and will be reviewed with the application as an optional addition to your submission.

Organizations that do not submit the required documentation or have incomplete applications will not be considered for funding through the Financial Inclusion Granting Program.

Funds must be used by the organization that is applying for the granting stream. For unincorporated associations, cheque will be issued to sponsoring incorporated organization.

Step Two: Request for Proposal

Once submitted to community.grants@alterna.ca, your application and subsequent documentation will be reviewed by Alterna Savings' Community Impact Department. Applications will be evaluated on several criteria including but not

limited to timeline of the initiative, alignment with the Financial Inclusion Granting Program criteria, and measurable results. The Community Impact team will invite a selection of organizations to submit full Proposals for Financial Inclusion Granting Program Committee consideration.

Step Three: Proposal Submission

Alterna Savings will only consider Proposals from organizations that have been selected to submit a full Proposal based on their previously submitted Financial Inclusion Granting Program Application.

In addition to expanding on the content requested within the application form, organizations will be asked to elaborate on the following topics in their Proposal:

- Detailed budget for your proposed Program/Project.
- Opportunities for Alterna Savings to be represented, collaborate, or have Alterna employees participate through your proposed Program/Project.
- Opportunities for program replication and/or impact to additional regions.
- Partnership opportunities with Alterna Savings that would allow for relationship fostering and program longevity.
- Any additional information for the benefit of the Financial Inclusion Granting Program Committee, including supporting information/documentation relevant to the submission.

Please note that the Financial Inclusion Granting Program Committee will review the Application Form and the Proposal Submission. It is strongly recommended to elaborate on the questions within the Application Form and the submission points noted above when compiling the organization's Proposal. We ask that Proposals do not exceed 3-pages in length.

Submit your completed Proposal in PDF format before the deadline to community.grants@alterna.ca.

Step Four: Proposal Review

Once submitted to community.grants@alterna.ca, your application, Proposal, and any supporting documentation will be reviewed by Alterna Savings' Financial Inclusion Granting Program Committee. Proposals will be evaluated on several criteria including but not limited to potential for replication or scale of the initiative, the proposed Program/Project impact, and measurable results.

Step Five: Approval

Alterna will inform all applicants of their submission status before recipient announcements. Successful applicants will be announced during Financial Literacy Month in November on all Alterna platforms. Funds must be used by the organization that is applying for the granting stream.

SIGNATURES

In order for your Grant Application to be eligible for funding, it must be completed and signed by an official representative who must have the capacity and be authorized to sign and submit this Grant Application Package. The person(s) signing this form certify(ies) and agree(s) with the following:

- a. I/We certify that I have the capacity, and that I/We am/are authorized in accordance with all internal policies, procedures, and by-laws of the organization, to sign and submit this Grant Application on behalf of the organization.
- b. I/We certify that the information provided in this Grant Application and any supporting documentation is true, accurate, and complete to the best of my/our knowledge.
- c. I/We give Alterna Savings and Credit Union Limited ("Alterna Savings") express consent to send emails which may contain credit union news, educational articles, and other promotional material on Alterna Savings' Product offers. I/We may withdraw our consent at any time. I/We may refer to Alterna Savings' privacy policy or contact an Alterna Savings representative for more details. Yes ☒ No ☐ SL (INITIAL) ☐ SL (INITIAL)
- d. I/We have read and understood the Alterna Savings Privacy Policy (available by calling 1.877.560.0100 or online at www.alterna.ca/onlinepolicies/securityandprivacy).
- e. I/We acknowledge that the information submitted within this application may be used and/or repurposed for generating your organization's profile should you be selected as a Financial Inclusion Granting Program recipient. I/We give Alterna Savings and Credit Union Limited express consent to use this content for promotional purposes (for example: Annual Summary, social media, etc.).

Sarah Lovenuk

Secretary Board Director

Name (please print)

Title



May 5, 2026

Signature

Date

Name (please print)

Title

Signature

Date

Get in Touch

Alterna's Community Impact Department can be reached at:

community@alterna.ca

community.grants@alterna.ca



Please contact our team should you have any questions throughout the application process or require support with your Financial Inclusion Granting Program submission. We look forward to receiving your information and submission and wish you good luck with your application. Thank you for your commitment and important work in the community space.

Alterna Savings and Credit Union Limited operates as Alterna Savings, a credit union in Ontario. For information on deposit insurance, please ask for a brochure at any Alterna branch or visit the Financial Services Regulatory Authority of Ontario's website: www.fsrdo.ca. (March 2026)